# UK SME Financial Health Dashboard — 2023 Stress Classification Snapshot

This dashboard analyses UK SME financial health across Retail, Hospitality and Construction using ONS Annual Business Survey data (2008–2023). Page 1: 2023 stress classification. Page 2: 16-year turnover trends. Page 3: detailed stress indicators 2019–2023 andPage 4: year on year trend analysis.

## Retail Stress Score (Max 3)

Total_Stress_Score
3

## Retail Gross Margin 2023

Gross Margin %
21.2

## Number of High Stress Sectors

Sector
1

## Stress Classification Table

| | Sector | Stress_Category | Gross_Margin_2023 |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Hospitality | Low | 50.05 |
| 2. | Construction | Low | 38.21 |
| 3. | Retail | High | 21.2 |

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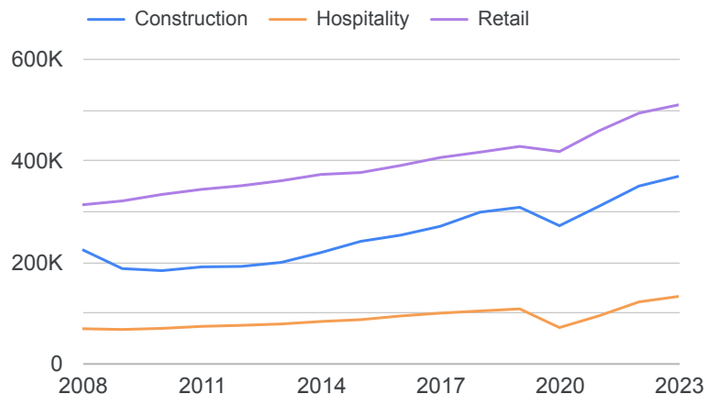
Retail is the only High stress sector in 2023 — scoring maximum stress flags across gross margin, cost ratio, and capital expenditure indicators.
Construction and Hospitality both score Low stress.

Author: Simran Anand | Data: ONS Annual Business Survey 2023 |
Tool: Looker Studio

# UK SME Sector Turnover Trends 2008–2023

## Sector turnover growth 2008–2023 (£m)




## Hospitality Gross Margin 2023

Gross Margin %

50.05

## Construction Gross Margin 2023

Gross Margin %

38.21

## Retail Gross Margin 2023

Gross Margin %

21.2

Retail consistently shows the lowest gross margin of the three sectors at 21.2% in 2023 — significantly below Hospitality (50.1%) and Construction (38.2%). This reflects Retail's high purchase costs relative to revenue, a persistent structural characteristic of the sector.

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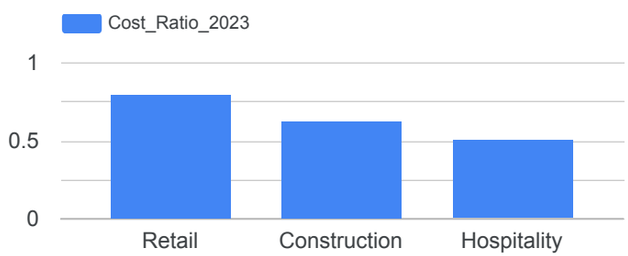
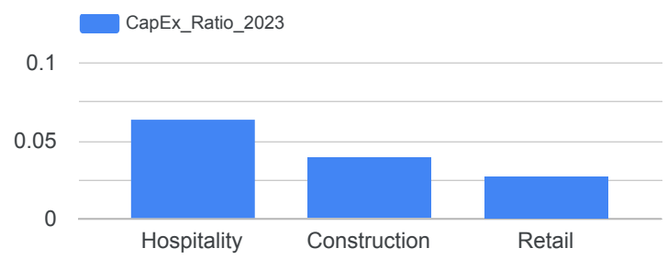
# SME Financial Stress Analysis — Retail, Hospitality & Construction 2019–2023

**Cost_Ratio_2023 by Sector - higher means more financial stress**




**CapEx_Ratio_2023 by Sector - lower means reduced investment**




**2023 stress classification by sector**

| | Sector | Stress_Category | Cost_Ratio_2023 ▾ | CapEx_Ratio_2023 | Gross_Margin_2023 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Retail | High | 0.79 | 0.03 | 21.2 |
| 2. | Construction | Low | 0.62 | 0.04 | 38.21 |
| 3. | Hospitality | Low | 0.5 | 0.06 | 50.05 |

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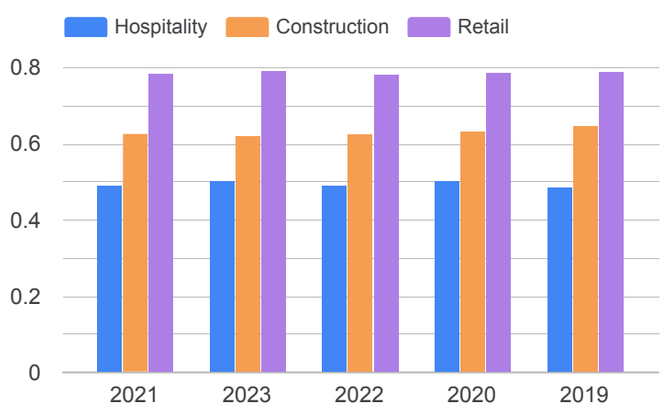
## Cost ratio trend by sector 2019–2023




**Key Finding** - Retail is the only sector classified as High stress — highest cost ratio at 0.79 and lowest CapEx investment at 0.03. Construction and Hospitality both score Low stress in 2023.

Author: Simran Anand | Data: ONS Annual Business Survey 2023 | Tool: Looker Studio

# Year on Year Financial Trend Analysis — 2019–2023

## Year on year change in gross margin and cost ratio by sector

| | Sector | Year | Trend | GM_YoY_Change | CR_YoY_Change |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Construction | 2020 | Improving | 1.42 | -0.01 |
| 2. | Hospitality | 2021 | Recovering | 1.15 | -0.01 |
| 3. | Construction | 2021 | Improving | 0.64 | -0.01 |
| 4. | Retail | 2021 | Stable | 0.44 | -0 |
| 5. | Construction | 2023 | Improving | 0.43 | -0 |
| 6. | Retail | 2020 | Stable | 0.16 | -0 |
| 7. | Construction | 2022 | Stable | 0.15 | -0 |
| 8. | Retail | 2022 | Stable | 0.07 | -0 |
| 9. | Hospitality | 2022 | Stable | -0.02 | 0 |
| 10. | Retail | 2023 | Deteriorating | -0.82 | 0.01 |
| 11. | Hospitality | 2023 | Deteriorating | -1.1 | 0.01 |
| 12. | Hospitality | 2020 | Deteriorating | -1.76 | 0.02 |

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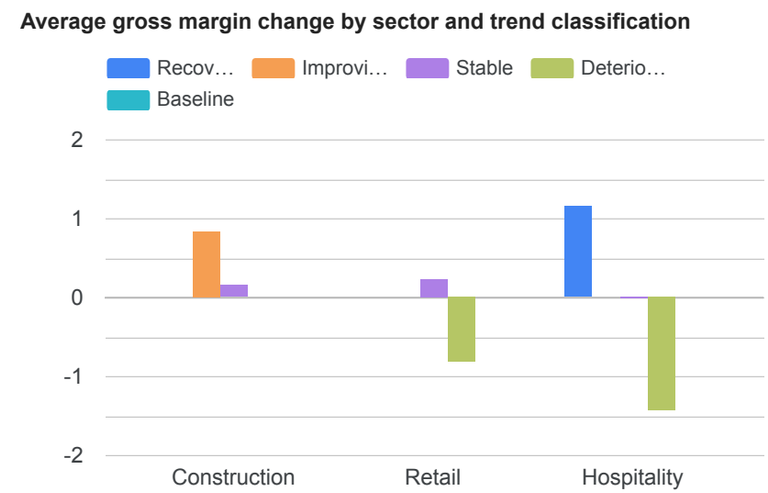


**Key Finding** - Retail is the only sector showing deteriorating gross margin in 2023 — falling 0.82 percentage points while cost ratio simultaneously increased. Hospitality also deteriorated in 2023 despite post-Covid recovery. Construction shows consistent improvement across all indicators.

Author: Simran Anand | Data: ONS Annual Business Survey 2023 | Tool: Looker Studio